

Tasks Module, Part 5: Wrap-up

What the test showed about the questions, and what we still need before the field

Everything here rests on **made-up** answers. The test checks the *questions and the method*. It says nothing yet about real workers.

1. What was done

Part	What it covers	File
Part 1	The 52 questions and where each comes from	W1_task_questions.pdf
Part 2	The made-up data and its checks	W2_test_data.pdf
Part 3	General results: tasks, jobs, overlap, hidden experience	W3_general_results.pdf
Part 4	The ropeway analysis: jobs, gates, count without work	W4_ropeway_results.pdf
Part 5	This wrap-up	W5_wrapup.pdf

The working list of steps is in CHECKLIST.md. All steps are ticked.

2. What the test showed about the questions

Keep

- **The 27-task grid with three answers.** It separates the jobs (job title explains about 38 in 100 of the differences between workers) and it also shows differences *inside* a job, which titles hide.
- **Answer 2 (“done before elsewhere”).** 79 in 100 workers gave at least one, most of them new to their job. It lowered the share of exposed workers who could take no job from 19 to 15 in 100. The change is modest but real.
- **Licence and certificate questions (T3).** For driver, guard, guide and technical jobs, the paper decides more than the tasks. Very few workers held an ITI, guard or guide paper, so these jobs were closed to nearly everyone.
- **Rare tasks** (engine, electrical, teaching, carrying a passenger). They look unimportant by count, but they are what technical ropeway jobs need.

Change or add

- **Add direct questions on exposure (module D).** Exposure by job title gave 26 workers, by main task 23, and by any carrying task 66. They cannot be swapped for each other.
- **Add a short employer or ropeway-operator questionnaire.** It must give (a) the number and kind of new jobs, (b) a full task list for each job (10 or more tasks), and (c) the papers each job needs. Without it the “unused skills” measure cannot be used and the result cannot be read.

- **Pilot the meaning of “done before”.** Ask about 10 people to explain the question back, then check that answer 2 rises with off-season work and past jobs. If it does not, the question is not working.
- **Plan for the small groups.** Guides and “Other” had 3 and 4 workers. The exposed jobs together gave 26 workers. That is too few for stable results; the real quota needs enough in each exposed job.

3. What we still need from outside the survey

Input	Why	Where it may come from
Number and kind of new jobs	The count without work depends on it more than on anything else	Ropeway project plan, developer, employer questionnaire
Totals of workers in each job	To scale from the sample to the region (the test only fixes drop-out)	Union and registration lists, tourism board counts
Full task lists for the new jobs	The national list gives only 1 to 3 tasks per job	Ropeway operator, hotel owners, existing ropeway sites
Papers each job requires	Gates decide many outcomes; three are our assumption (operator, mechanic, guide)	Uttarakhand tourism rules, ITI and NSQF bodies, operator
Union check of the 27 tasks	Palki and dandi work has no national code	Pony, palki and porter unions
Exact wording of STEP lifting and repetition questions	Our file shows only shortened labels	Original STEP questionnaire
Open round with 30 to 40 workers	To find tasks the list is missing (Sengupta et al. 2021)	Field team
Translation and picture cards	Questions are read aloud, and nobody needs to read	Field team, 10 test interviews

4. Results that must be shown as ranges

The count of workers without a job, in the middle case, was 69 in 100 (best case) or 71 in 100 (lottery), against 50 in 100 when only numbers are counted. It moves a lot with the shortage cut, the gate rules, the job supply and the job mix (Part 4, sections 7 and 8). Any real report should show a table like those, and not one number.

5. Decisions still open (yours)

1. Add the employer or ropeway-operator mini-module to the survey plan?
2. Test reading and counting directly (a few simple tasks) instead of asking, or keep questions T3_01 to T3_05 as they are?
3. Confirm the list of destination jobs, or replace it after the union and employer checks.
4. The parts on *readiness for a new job* and *preferences and barriers* (T4 and T5) are not written yet. They involve asking about future or hypothetical situations, so we need to decide how far to go with them.
5. Employment-poverty questions (the Apablaza core) are ready to be added when you want them.